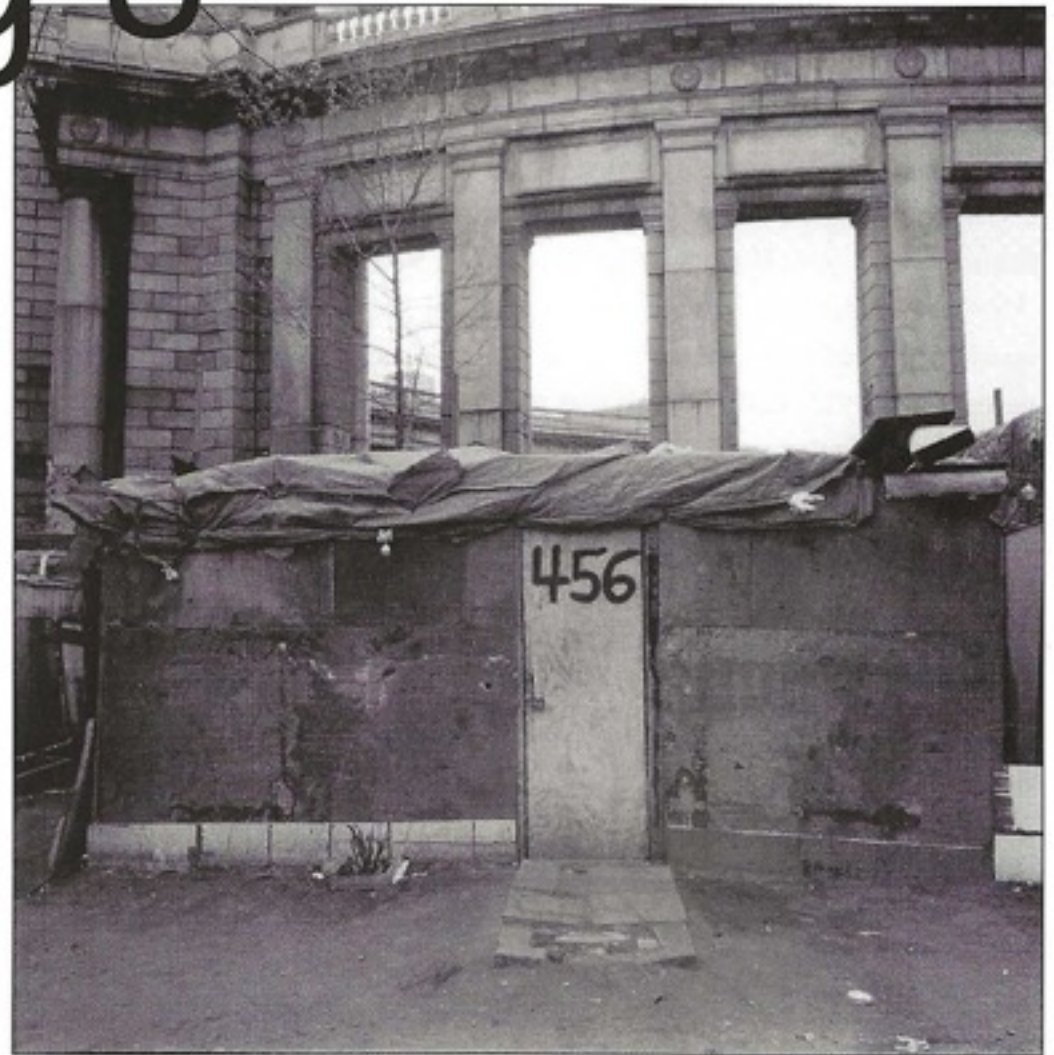


fragile -ings

Photographs and text by Margaret Morton



Ivan's First House, 1991
[boards against fence]



Ivan's Second House, 1992
[with little plant in front]

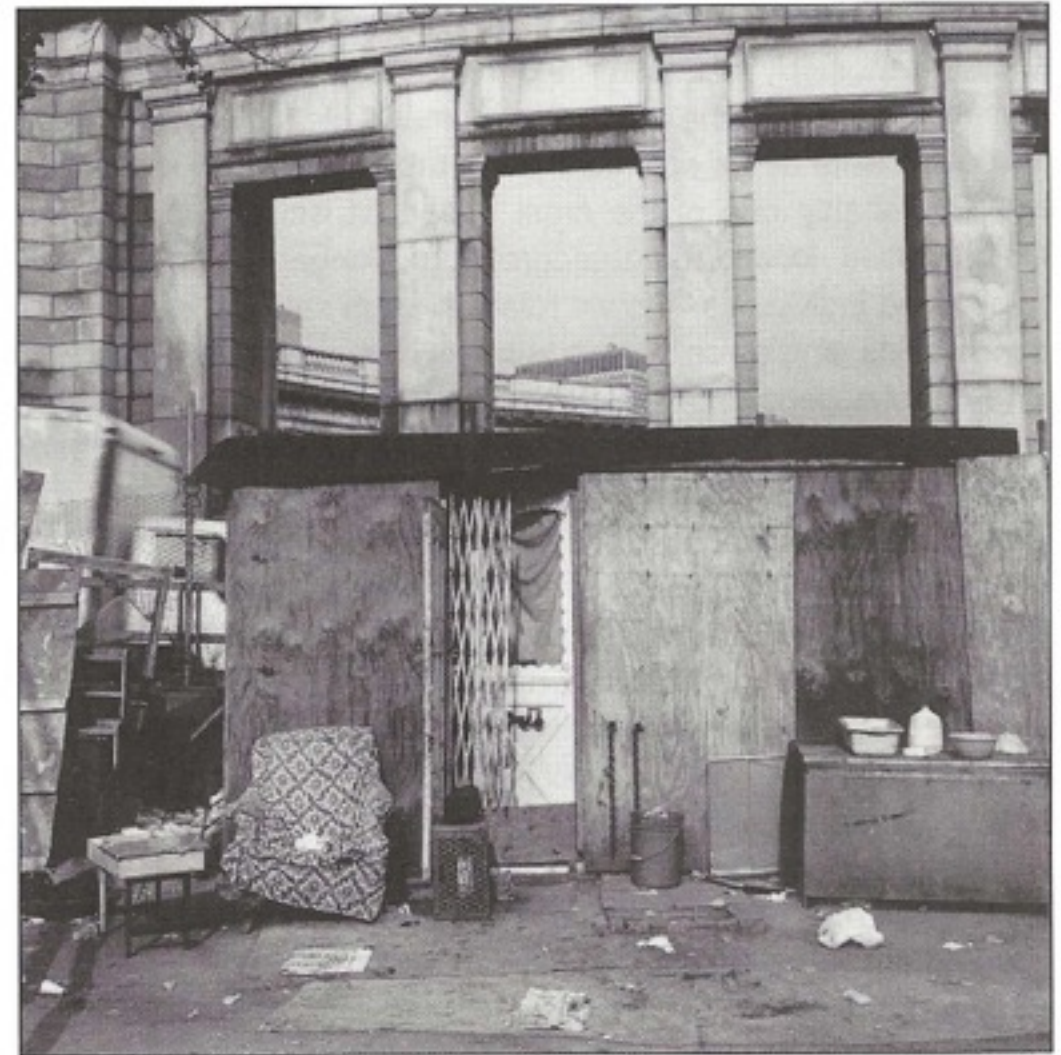
The Hill
The Site: is a triangular plot of land in Chinatown, adjacent to the entry ramp of the Manhattan Bridge. A small park when the bridge opened in 1907, it became home in the 1980s to twenty-five people. The Hill's structures were bulldozed by the municipal sanitation department in August 1993.

The House:
 In February 1991, Ivan built a shed by propping wooden boards and plastic sheets against a chain-link fence. The next year, with help from a neighbor, he reassembled the plywood to form a freestanding structure with a front door, stone walkway, and raised flower bed.

When Ivan left the Hill, the new occupants, Shaft and Lisa, asked



Shaft and Lisa's House, Christmas 1992
 [with Christmas decorations]



Shaft and Lisa's House, 1993
 [with chair and "dutch door"]

Louie Watson to make a few improvements to the structure. Louie was known as "the architect" because he built dwellings for many Hill residents. He raised the roof, sloped it for better drainage, and covered it with waterproof canvas. To complete the renovation, he painted the house bright blue.

After the house burned in February 1993, Shaft paid Louie five dollars to rebuild it. A neighbor donated a Dutch Colonial screen door.

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